implemented limited security measures at the Taj. However, no significant steps were taken to harden its perimeter or increase police vigilance and the temporary security enhancements were lifted weeks before the attacks. The police admitted they did not have the overall manpower to maintain a presence, nor were the personnel they could have posted at the hotels trained to deal with a terrorist attack.[49] This was borne out during the assault. As first responders, the Mumbai police were wholly unprepared to deal with the situation. To begin with, there simply were not enough of them. Ajai Sahni, a terrorism analyst based in Delhi, had been criticizing India's low police-to-population ratio since well before the 2008 attacks. The United Nations recommends, on average, 250 police per 100,000 citizens for normal, peacetime policing. India, which is forced to contend with numerous active insurgencies, had approximately 125 police per 100,000 people as of 2007, or half of the recommended number. Most police officers did not have the proper weaponry or body armor to contend with the threat posed by well-trained and well-armed commandos. Many of them were unarmed and some of those who initially responded to the attacks were equipped with 0.303 bolt-action rifles, similar to those the British army used in the 1950s. Most officers also had only a 5mm plastic protector—useful as riot gear—rather than bullet-resistant vests.[50]

Local army units arrived five hours after the attacks began. The Marine Commandos [Marcos], who were the first special response team on site, got there soon afterwards. However, they pulled out before engaging. An Indian cabinet minister proclaimed that 200 National Security Guard Commandos [known as the NSG, or Black Cats because of their uniforms] would be deployed in the next two hours. Because Lashkar handlers were monitoring the news from Pakistan and communicating with the attackers in Mumbai, this enabled them to provide two key pieces of information to the fidayeen.[51] The terrorists were now aware that no special operators were active in the area and, based on those operators' scheduled arrival, they also knew when to expect a rescue mission to begin.

The NSG, modeled on the British Special Air Service [SAS] and created for this type of counter-terrorism operation, did not arrive until 08:50 the next day. Their tardiness exposed inadequate planning and logistical capabilities. First, the NSG were headquartered in Delhi and at the time of the attacks had no bases anywhere else in the country.[52] Nor did they have